Ideation Phase

Brainstorm & Idea Prioritization Template

Date	02 October 2026
Team ID	SWTID-2026-9088
Project Name	Import Data using Transform Maps (Spreadsheet)
Maximum Marks	4 Marks

Brainstorm & Idea Prioritization

Brainstorming is used to explore possible approaches to the employee-data import problem before selecting the implementation approach. For this project, the ideas focus on importing spreadsheet data into ServiceNow, validating records, preventing duplicates, and providing useful visibility through reports and dashboards.

Problem Statement: Employee data received in spreadsheet format needs to be imported into ServiceNow efficiently and accurately. The process should support field mapping, validation, updates to existing employees, prevention of duplicate records, and visibility of the resulting employee data.

Step-1: Team Gathering, Collaboration and Select the Problem Statement

Activity	Project-specific outcome
Team gathering	Discuss the employee-data import and migration requirement.
Problem identification	Manual entry of spreadsheet records can be time-consuming and error-prone.
Goal definition	Create a repeatable ServiceNow process for spreadsheet-to-table data migration.
Problem selected	Import structured employee spreadsheet data into ServiceNow while maintaining data integrity.

Selected problem statement: Design a ServiceNow-based employee data import process that loads spreadsheet data into an Import Set, transforms it into a custom Employee Test table, handles repeated imports without duplicate records, and provides reports/dashboard visibility.

Step-2: Brainstorm, Idea Listing and Grouping

The following ideas represent the main approaches relevant to the selected employee-data import problem.

Idea	Description	Group
1. Manual data entry	Enter employee records individually into the ServiceNow table.	Data Entry
2. Import Set + Transform Map	Load spreadsheet data into a staging Import Set and transform it into Employee Test.	Data Migration
3. Coalesce-based duplicate control	Use a unique employee identifier to update existing records instead of inserting duplicates.	Data Integrity
4. Employee reports	Create department, location and employee-list reports for imported data.	Analytics
5. Employee Analytics Dashboard	Combine the reports into a centralized dashboard for quick monitoring.	Analytics
6. Repeated-import validation	Re-import data and verify inserted, updated and ignored records.	Validation

Idea Grouping

Group	Ideas included
Data Entry	Manual data entry
Data Migration	Import Set + Transform Map
Data Integrity	Coalesce-based duplicate control
Analytics	Employee reports; Employee Analytics Dashboard
Validation	Repeated-import validation

Grouping outcome: The brainstormed ideas cover the complete workflow from importing data to maintaining data integrity and presenting useful employee information.

Step-3: Idea Prioritization

Ideas are prioritized according to their importance to the project objective and their feasibility within the ServiceNow environment.

Idea	Importance	Feasibility	Priority
Import Set + Transform Map	High	High	Selected
Coalesce duplicate control	High	High	Selected
Repeated-import validation	High	High	Selected
Employee reports	Medium	High	Included
Employee Analytics Dashboard	Medium	High	Included
Manual data entry	Low	High	Not selected as main approach

Selected Solution

The prioritized solution is an end-to-end ServiceNow Import Set and Transform Map workflow. Coalesce is used to protect data integrity during repeated imports, while employee reports and the Employee Analytics Dashboard provide visibility into the resulting records.

Project Alignment

This Phase 1 document prepares the ideation content required for the project. The supplied project material describes the implemented ServiceNow workflow but does not contain a historical record of the team's original brainstorming discussion. Therefore, the ideas and prioritization above are explicitly project-aligned content prepared for this documentation.

Reference

The supplied brainstorming template organizes this activity into team gathering/problem selection, idea listing and grouping, and idea prioritization.